



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chi Rho Classical Academy
School Website: <https://chirhoclassical.wordpress.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chi Rho Classical Academy (Danville, KY, 40422) presents a coherent classical Christian educational program with clear religious foundations, a stated aim of forming character through wisdom and virtue, and a curriculum that centers the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) along with Latin, Great Books/primary texts, and a structured memory-work component. Public materials emphasize a liturgical, communal, and parent-partnered approach to schooling, with explicit mention of the Apostle's Creed, Catholic tradition, and the Magisterium, alongside a Classical Core Curriculum and trivium-based pedagogy. The school's public messaging also highlights Socratic/seminal discussion at the upper levels, a memory-based lower-school culture (recitation/memory work), and a faculty model described as mentors and living exemplars, all wrapped within a community that invites parental involvement and transparency (tours, open visits, and homeschool partnerships).

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials foreground a Christ-centered framework: "Traditional Education Rooted In Christ" and explicit invocation of a Christian community identity. - The Apostles' Creed, Holy Scriptures, and Catholic tradition are cited as core beliefs guiding instruction. - Liturgical/memorial practices appear in routines (Morning Assembly with Prayer and Memory Work; Mass on Tuesdays).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth/goodness/beauty language (through the classical Christian framework), theology, liturgy, worship, creed, sacred scripture, and catechesis-like formation. The site explicitly anchors education in the Good, the True, and the Beautiful via Classical Christian framing. - No salient negative religious-secular signals detected in public materials.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) through a Christ-centered, liturgical, creed-based context and explicitly binds curriculum to religious formation. This aligns strongly with classical expectations for religious and metaphysical foundations.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword indicators (religious/metaphysical): high; Negative indicators: none observed in public content.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation of wisdom and virtue through the liberal arts and Christ's teachings: "grow in wisdom, knowledge, and virtue through the study of the liberal arts and humanities and the teachings of Christ." - Emphasis on formation over mere information; cultivation of humanity and virtue is foregrounded through the liberal arts, with explicit purpose to form students rather than simply prepare for work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation; virtue; wisdom; human flourishing; liberal arts education; contemplation/rest; unity of truth/beauty/goodness. The website frames education as the formation of character and affirms transcendental aims, consistent with classical telos. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (no explicit focus on workforce-readiness as primary telos).

Why this rating - The school's stated telos centers on virtue, wisdom, and formation via Christ-centered liberal-arts study, matching the classical aims of paideia rather than a job-readiness focus.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword indicators strong; Negative indicators minimal or absent.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit reference to liberal arts structure: grammar, logic, rhetoric; introduction of Latin; a trivium-based approach; emphasis on memory work in the grammar stage; Great Books/Great Conversation framing appears in classical discussions and curriculum pages. - Curriculum materials highlight the Classical Core Curriculum with cycles like The Ancient World; memory work; and materials from Catholic Schoolhouse; Books by Grade Level. - The school's general description explicitly states a classical curriculum and a Trivium-based model; the mission mentions "liberal arts and humanities" and the "teachings of Christ."

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation, memory work/recitation, history integrated with the classical approach, and the integrated/harmonious curriculum. The public materials consistently frame curriculum within classical canon and primary-text engagement. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (no clear shift toward social studies-centric or strictly project-based modern curricula that would conflict with classical norms).

Why this rating - The curriculum aligns with classical expectations through grammar-logic-rhetoric, Latin, Great Books/primary texts, and historical integration, supported by explicit curriculum materials and cycle-based study plans.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword indicators strong; Negative indicators minimal or absent.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school practices include singing and memory work, with regular review and a contemplative/joyful approach in line with Scholé-style rhythms. The public materials show daily memory work and a rhythm conducive to memorization and delight in learning. - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and deliberate rhetoric training; opportunities for students to give speeches and engage in rhetorical practice are described in classical-school materials. - The "What is a Classical School?" narrative and the site's classical framework signaling that education integrates contemplative/restful elements alongside rigorous exploration.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, chanting, Socratic seminars, rhetoric training, lectures/discussions, living curriculum in practice, and hearing memory-work as a core tradition. The site explicitly maps to these methods. - Negative indicators: minimal; the site does include rigorous elements (Socratic/seminar-based upper-school), which aligns with classical pedagogy rather than signaling a non-classical approach.

Why this rating - Pedagogical methods map closely to classical expectations: contemplative/restful components balanced with Socratic dialogue and rhetoric in the upper grades, alongside memory work and recitation in the lower grades.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword indicators: high (Socratic/seminar; memory work; recitation; liturgical rhythm; rhetoric; scholé). Negative indicators: none observed.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Our Tutors/Meet Our Teachers pages highlight a team of experienced educators (Founding director, grammar/intensive teachers, Montessori director) with specific roles and a defined faculty structure. This includes named individuals with credentials and long-term involvement. - The school presents the faculty as a living curriculum and as mentors; a portrait of what a teacher should be and what a student should be is implied by the classical-education framing and explicit staff profiles. - The Code of Conduct

page presents teacher-student expectations and the ethical/moral dimension of the faculty's role, reinforcing virtue-formation through modeled behavior.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: model of virtue; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; collegial culture; moral formation; teacher as exemplar. The site explicitly provides faculty profiles and emphasizes virtue and mentorship. - Negative indicators: none evident in public content.

Why this rating - Faculty are framed as virtuous exemplars and mentors aligned with classical pedagogy; "living curriculum" and portraits of teachers are embedded in the site's materials.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword indicators strong; Negative indicators absent.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes partnership with families, open parent involvement, and co-educator roles for parents; the hybrid homeschool-support model shows explicit collaboration with families. - Language about parental rights and responsibilities in education (quotations from Catholic/Family messaging) and explicit calls for parent engagement (tours, information packets) indicate an open, partnership-driven approach. - The school invites parental participation and emphasizes pastoral/educational formation for families (e.g., book studies and family catechesis via public materials). The tuition/participation materials also reflect a family-centric model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with families; parents as co-teachers; parental formation; open campus/visits; family-centered culture; home-school hybrid options; community of learners. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials; no indication of parent passivity or consumer-facing-only engagement in the provided content.

Why this rating - The public materials present a robust, classical-friendly model of parent engagement and family partnership, aligning with the recommended "Parents and Community" elements of classical education.

Quantitative note - Positive keyword indicators strong; Negative indicators absent.

Aggregate Assessment and Ranking - All six categories: CLASSICAL - Overall classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle - No major needle-moving changes are required. The public-facing materials already align with Classical criteria across all six categories. If any enhancement were desired, it would be to further codify explicit references to "Great Books," "Great Conversation," and a more explicit enum of the Trivium/Quadrivium framework in a single curriculum overview page for quick stakeholder reference, though these elements are already present in the school's broader materials (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, memory work, and classical curriculum statements).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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